

Zijin Mining/Zijin Gold

First Take: Slight miss but maintain top pick

Our First Take: Zijin Mining issued its 1H26 profit alert, with implied 2Q26 reported/core earnings of Rmb19.0bn (-5% QoQ, +45% YoY)/19.4bn (+5% QoQ, +66% YoY) coming in below JPMe (Rmb21.5bn); 1H26 reported/core earnings were Rmb39.1bn/Rmb37.9bn, representing 49%/48% of JPMe/BBGe FY26 estimates and slightly below JPMe (Rmb38.9bn), respectively. Separately, **Zijin Gold's** 1H26 profit alert points to implied 2Q26 earnings of ~USD590mn (-27% QoQ, +67% YoY) were a miss (JPMe: USD830mn), while 1H26 reported estimated earnings of USD1.4bn (+169% YoY) accounted for 42%/41% of JPMe/BBGe FY26 estimates. Considering the 2Q26 gold/copper prices (Rmb992/g/Rmb103k/t; -9%/+2% QoQ), we believe the miss in results of both Zijin Mining and Zijin Gold can be attributed to a lower gold price, lower-than-expected target production completion rates (<50% vs FY26 guidance for copper and gold) and more pronounced cost inflation. We maintain Zijin Mining as our top pick as we expect most of the volume ramp-up to be concentrated in 2H26.

Key Question Marks

- **Both production volumes tracking below 50%.** In 1H26, Zijin Mining reported production volumes of 47t for gold, 534kt for copper and 43kt for lithium, representing 42%/45%, 48%/45% and 35%/36% of FY JPMe/guidance, respectively. Gold and copper output was modestly below our expected 1H phasing. Lithium output was broadly in line, with Manono's contribution expected to be more visible in 2H26. Zijin Gold reported ~27t of mine-produced gold output, tracking 45%/46% of FY JPMe/guidance. In our view, slower-than-expected gold and copper volume release was one of the key drivers of the earnings miss.
- **Cost likely to be the drag.** Zijin Gold's earnings miss was also largely attributable to higher-than-expected costs (i.e. diesel and royalties cost), in our view. The company has not provided detailed information on cost inflation, and we await further management guidance on the cost trajectory for the rest of 2026.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect consensus earnings for Zijin Mining to remain muted while Zijin Gold could be revised down as (1) production volume tracks below 50% of company guidance; (2) commodity prices, especially the gold price, remain under pressure due to rate hike expectation changes and geopolitical uncertainty; and (3) uncertainty of production cost trajectory.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a muted to negative price reaction for both Zijin Mining and Zijin Gold, with investor focus remaining on commodity price trends, US-Iran talks and interest rate decisions.

See page 5 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

**FIRST
TAKE**



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Overweight

Price (09 Jul 26): Rmb27.62

Price Target (Dec-27): Rmb46.00

2899.HK, 2899 HK

Overweight

Price (09 Jul 26): HK\$29.42

Price Target (Dec-27): HK\$50.00

2259.HK, 2259 HK

Overweight

Price (09 Jul 26): HK\$99.70

Price Target (Dec-27): HK\$170.00

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Zijin Mining - A *(Overweight; Price Target: Rmb46.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are positive on both copper and gold, which accounted for 36% and 43% of the company's gross profit in 2025, respectively. We believe tighter supply/demand should drive the next leg of the copper price rally. Zijin's good track record of mine expansion with good cost control could also support its >10% CAGR volume growth target into 2028. We rate the stock OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-27 PT of Rmb46 is based on a DCF valuation with a WACC of 13% and a terminal growth rate of 2%. Our PT implies a FY27E P/E multiple of 13x and a FY27E EV/EBITDA multiple of 8x.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside risks include: (1) the risk of overpayment on M&A relative to eventual returns; (2) geopolitical risks surrounding Zijin's overseas mines; (3) weaker-than-expected gold and copper prices; and (4) delay or non-completion of the Allied Gold and/or Chifeng acquisitions, which would result in downside to our base case production and earnings forecasts.

Upside catalysts include: (1) stronger-than-expected gold and copper prices; and (2) stronger-than-expected volume growth, either organic or inorganic.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Zijin Mining – H (*Overweight; Price Target: HK\$50.00*)

Investment Thesis

We are positive on both copper and gold, which accounted for 36% and 43% of the company's gross profit in 2025, respectively. We believe tighter supply/demand should drive the next leg of the copper price rally. Zijin's good track record of mine expansion with good cost control could also support its >10% CAGR volume growth target into 2028. We rate the stock OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-27 PT of HK\$50 is based on a 6% average 3-month A/H premium on our A-share PT. The PT implies a FY27E P/E multiple of 12x and a FY27E EV/EBITDA multiple of 7x.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside risks include: (1) the risk of overpayment on M&A relative to eventual returns; (2) geopolitical risks surrounding Zijin's overseas mines; (3) weaker-than-expected gold and copper prices; and (4) delay or non-completion of the Allied Gold and/or Chifeng acquisitions, which would result in downside to our base case production and earnings forecasts.

Upside catalysts include: (1) stronger-than-expected gold and copper prices; and (2) stronger-than-expected volume growth, either organic or inorganic.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Zijin Gold International - H *(Overweight; Price Target: HK\$170.00)*

Investment Thesis

Zijin Gold, a subsidiary of Zijin Mining, has established a strong growth platform through acquisitions and reserve expansion, achieving a 15% CAGR in gold production from 2023 to 2025. Operating nine mines across four continents, the company is expanding capacity at key sites. Our base case assumes the Allied Gold acquisition closes in 3Q26 and contributes from 4Q26, bringing 2026 gold production to 60t. The company expects the acquisition to add up to 25t by 2029; even without it, existing mines should deliver a 15% CAGR. Zijin Gold's disciplined acquisition strategy drives improving capital efficiency, with ROLTA reaching 29% in 2025 (vs. 12% in 2024). With a favorable gold price outlook and robust growth pipeline, we forecast earnings to grow at a 42% CAGR from 2025 to 2028. We have an OW rating and Dec-27 PT of HK\$170.

Valuation

Our Dec-27 price target of HK\$170 is based on a DCF valuation with a WACC of 8.5% and a terminal growth rate of 2.5%. Our PT implies a FY27E P/E multiple of 13x and a FY27E EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.5x.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Key downside risks to our rating and price target include: 1) gold price volatility; 2) operational risks arising from exposure to multiple foreign jurisdictions, project construction delays, and illegal mining activities at the Buriticá gold mine in Colombia; 3) lower-than-expected realized prices for mineral products; and 4) delay or non-completion of the Allied Gold acquisition, which would result in downside to our base case production and earnings forecasts.

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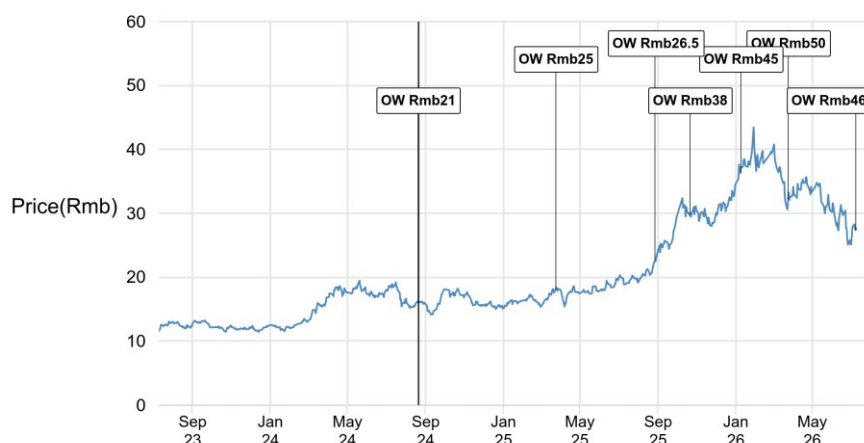
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Zijin Mining - A (601899.SS, 601899 CH) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 03, 2014. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.
Break in coverage Jun 15, 2023 - Aug 20, 2024.

Date	Rating	Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)
20-Aug-24	OW	16.22	21
25-Mar-25	OW	18.05	25
28-Aug-25	OW	22.53	26.5
21-Oct-25	OW	29.75	38
09-Jan-26	OW	36.30	45
25-Mar-26	OW	32.20	50
09-Jul-26	OW	27.36	46

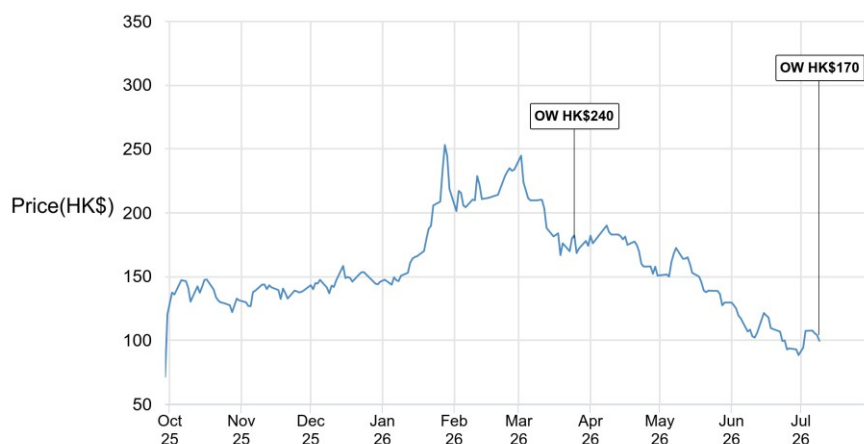
Zijin Mining – H (2899.HK, 2899 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 06, 2006. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.
Break in coverage Jun 15, 2023 - Aug 20, 2024.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
20-Aug-24	OW	16.06	20
25-Mar-25	OW	18.14	23.7
28-Aug-25	OW	24.74	28
21-Oct-25	OW	32.46	42
09-Jan-26	OW	37.20	48
25-Mar-26	OW	34.86	55
09-Jul-26	OW	29.74	50

Zijin Gold International - H (2259.HK, 2259 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Mar 24, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
25-Mar-26	OW	180.10	240
09-Jul-26	OW	104.30	170

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